

have any trouble reading the fine print in the WSJ when she is checking her Esso stock. That would have been around 1971 and somehow that is still in the recesses of my mind.

Now if one thinks this 100-bagger goal is unachievable, just consider as a young kid if I had just started accumulating ExxonMobil back then. It would not have taken a genius or much of a stock picker gene. Just buy the largest oil stock in the world that had been around for a hundred years. ... Just put your blinders on and keep accumulating over a lifetime. No stress, no white knuckles since it has a very conservative balance sheet, no high wire act.

So where [sic] would \$1 back in 1971 in Esso be worth today? By my calculations \$418 plus one would have been collecting a juicy dividend all those years.

Amazing, isn't it? Everybody has a story somewhat like these.

All right, one more, because these are so interesting:

In about 1969/1970, when a billboard in downtown Seattle read, "Will the Last Person Turn Out the Lights?" a friend of mine had just sold an apartment house in Seattle and netted about \$100,000 after tax. His view was that things couldn't get any worse for Boeing so he bought 10,000 shares at \$9.50/share. Within about 10 years or so he was getting annual cash dividends for almost as much as he had paid for the stock. This had to be a 100 plus bagger with all of the stock dividends and splits over the years. In 2002 I believe he still had not sold a share.

Key here is the idea that you must sit still. Think of all the reasons to sell Boeing since 1970: Inflation. Wars. Interest-rate worries. Economic fears. The list of reasons to sell is always long. But if you've done the job of picking right, you're better off holding on.

This reminds me of an anecdote by Chris Mittleman, an exceptional investor, published in one of his shareholder letters. An excerpt appeared in *Value Investor Insight*. Savor this:

Imagine if a friend had introduced you to Warren Buffett in 1972 and told you, "I've made a fortune investing with this Buffett guy